



2026 growth investment: fix retention before adding sales capacity

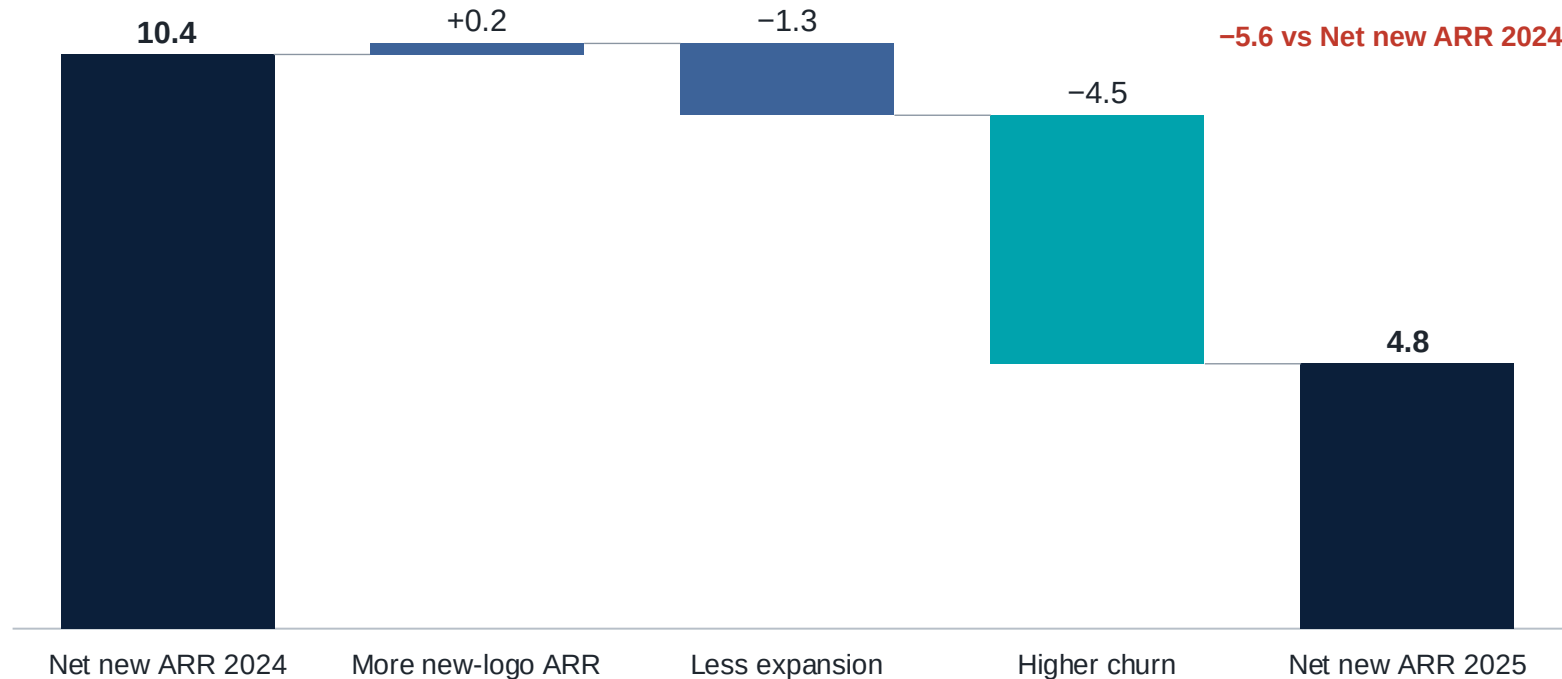
Board discussion: why ARR growth slowed and where the 2026 budget should go

Churn, not sales, cut net new ARR by €5.6M; we recommend a retention-first plan at an estimated €2.0M a year instead of €3.6M for 30 AEs

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|---|--|--|
| 1 | Churn, not sales, broke growth | Net new ARR fell €5.6M to €4.8M; higher churn explains 80.4% while pipeline grew 18.0%. |
| 2 | The leak is in first-year customers | First-year churn rose from 12% to 26% after a €0.8M onboarding cut, costing €2.5M of ARR. |
| 3 | The 30-AE plan does not hold | With a 9-month ramp, 30 AEs yield at most an estimated €4.5M in 2026, not €9M. |
| 4 | Retention first closes most of the gap for less | Onboarding plus 10 AEs: an estimated €2.0M a year for up to €5.3M of the €5.6M; AE wave 2 gated in June. |

Higher churn explains 80.4% of the €5.6M fall in net new ARR; new-logo ARR still grew €0.2M

Net new ARR bridge, 2024 to 2025, €M



Churn, not acquisition, broke the bridge

- **Churn (-€4.5M), 80.4% of the fall:** churned ARR more than doubled, from €3.3M to €7.8M
- **Expansion (-€1.3M):** fell from €4.3M to €3.0M; cause not yet established
- **New logos (+€0.2M):** €9.4M to €9.6M; acquisition held up

The sales engine did not break: pipeline grew 18.0%, deals won rose from 175 to 193 and only 31% of churned customers cite a competitor or price

+18.0%

Pipeline created, €38.9M to €45.9M (2024 to 2025)

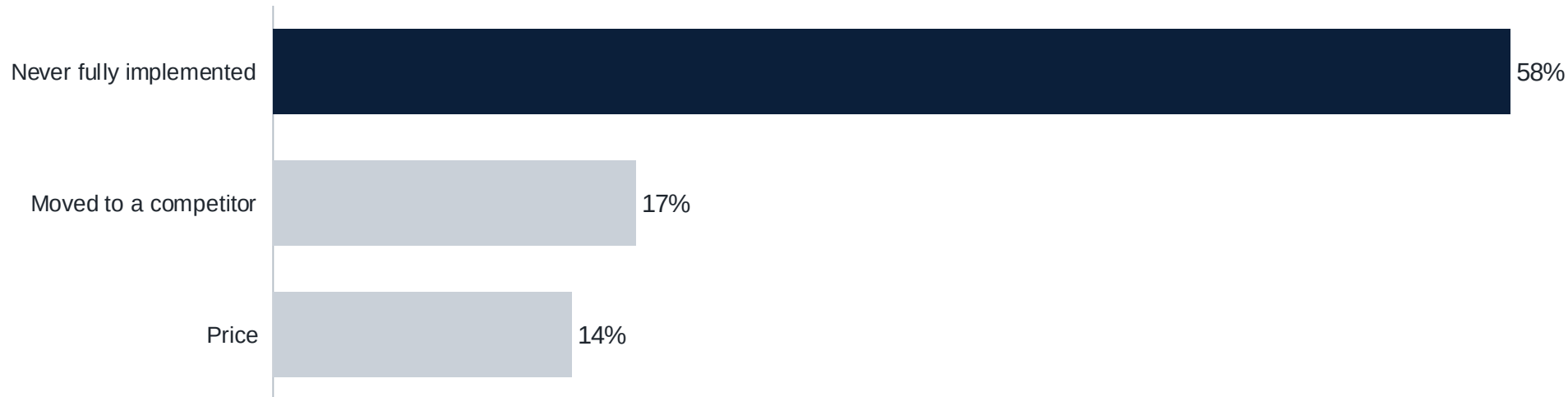
175 → 193

Deals won, 2024 to 2025

23-25%

Quarterly win rate, stable through 2024-25

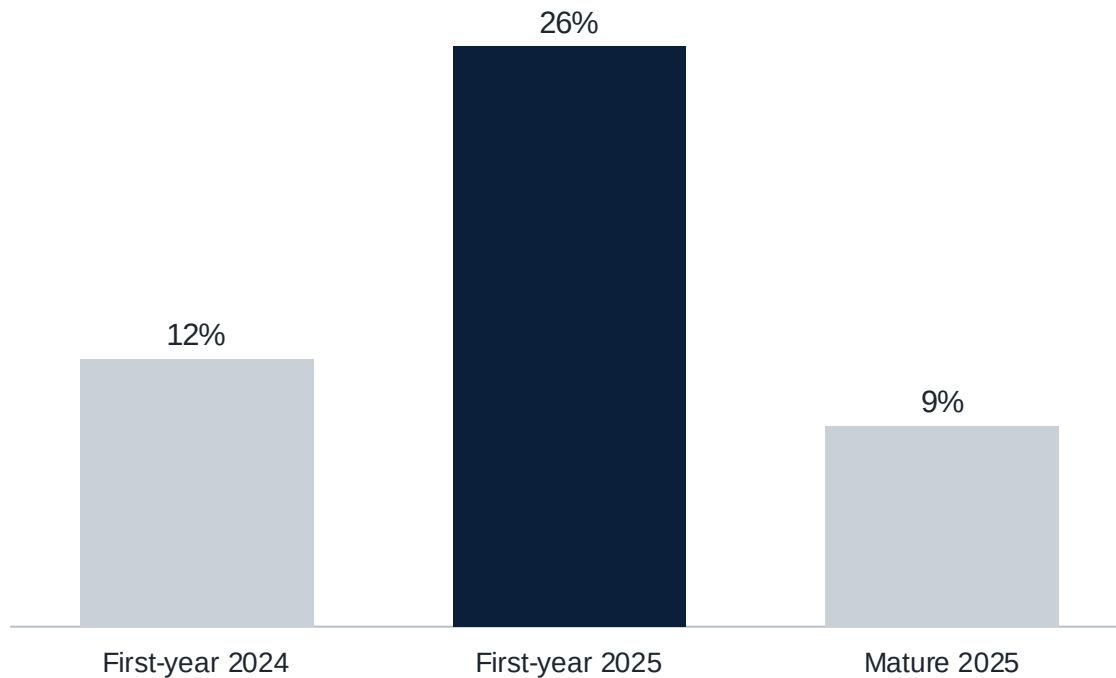
Reasons given by churned customers, 2025 exit interviews (n=64), % of churned customers



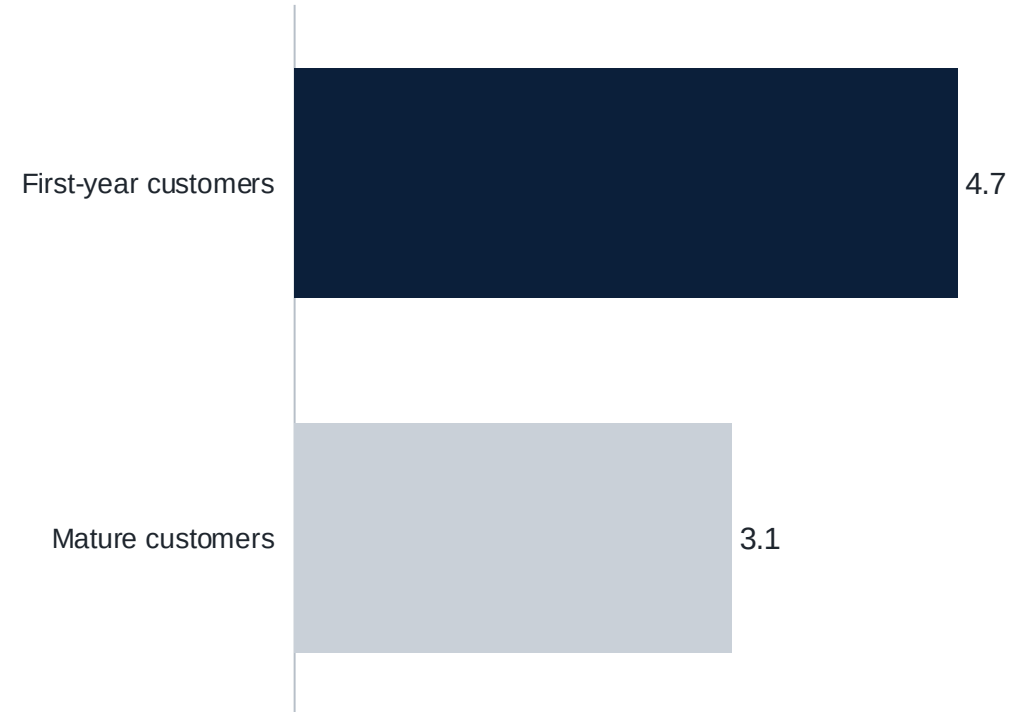
Price pressure is real but marginal: new ARR per deal slipped from €53.7k to €49.7k; price is 34% of lost deals

First-year customers churned 26% versus 12% in 2024 and supplied 60.3% of churned ARR; mature customers churned 9%

Churn rate by customer tenure, % of opening ARR

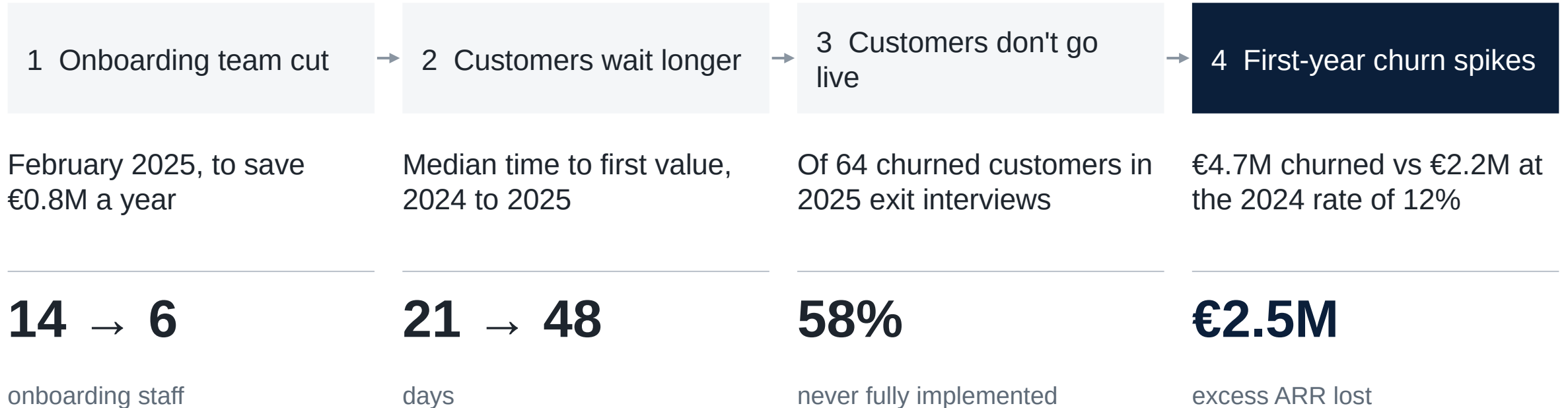


Churned ARR by tenure, 2025, €M



First-year customers supplied €4.7M of the €7.8M churned (60.3%): the leak is in onboarding, not in the mature base

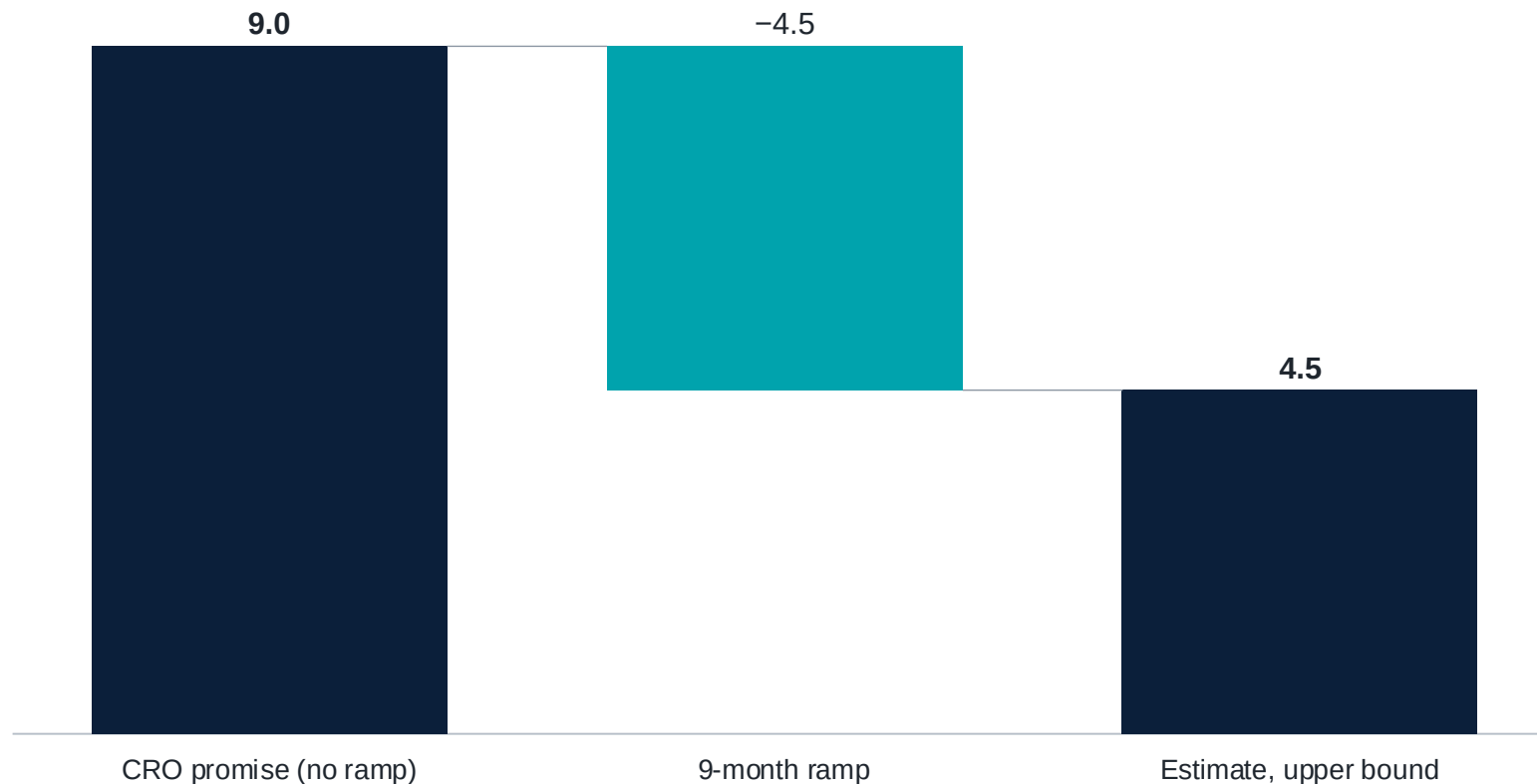
Cutting onboarding saved €0.8M but more than doubled time to first value (21 to 48 days) and cost about €2.5M of ARR



Restoring the team is lever L1; causality is inferred from timing and exit interviews, not a controlled test

30 AEs hired in Q1 deliver at most an estimated €4.5M in 2026, not €9M, because new AEs need 9 months to reach €300k (assumes a linear ramp)

2026 new ARR from 30 AEs hired in Q1 2026, €M



Why €9M does not hold

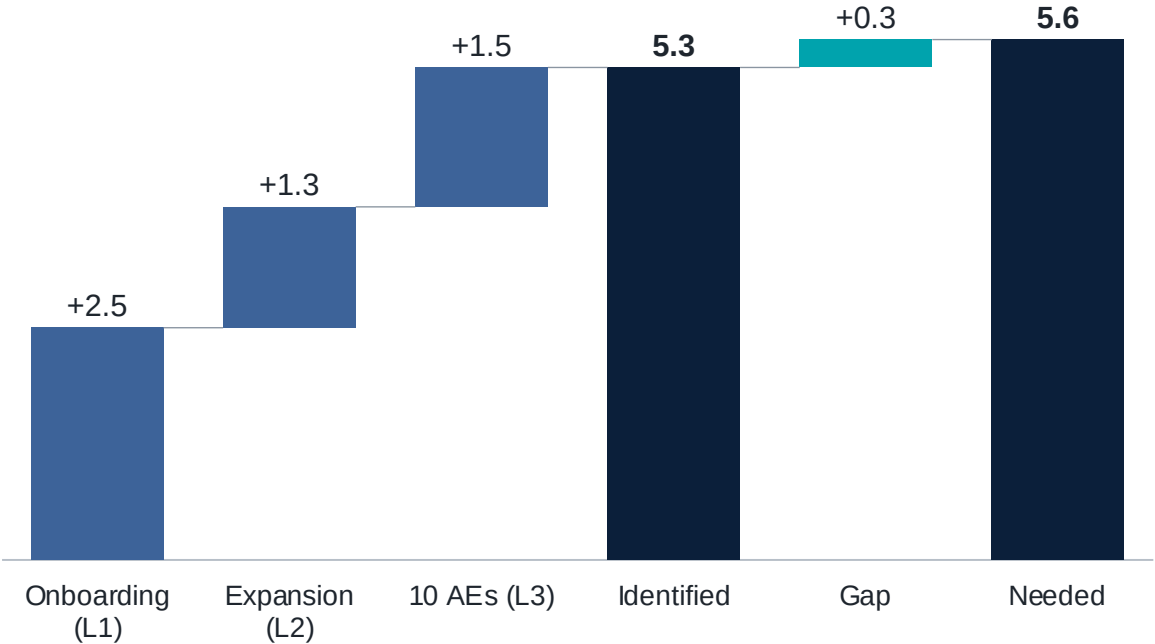
- **€9M = 30 AEs × €300k × 12 months:** every AE fully productive from day one
- **Ramp:** a Q1 hire gives about 6 productive months in 2026 (our assumption, note 1)
- **Cost:** €3.6M a year fully loaded, €0.12M per AE
- **Validate:** ramp of the 2025 AE hires before any offer letter

Retention first costs an estimated €2.0M versus €3.6M and identifies up to €5.3M of the €5.6M needed, leaving an estimated €0.3M gap (levers are upper bounds)

Options, costed on the same annual basis

Option	€M a year	2026 ARR effect, €M	Fixes leak
Keep CRO plan: 30 AEs in Q1	3.6	≤4.5, new logos only	No
Retention first: onboarding + 10 AEs, wave 2 gated	2.0 (est.)	≤5.3	Yes
Onboarding only, no new AEs	0.8	≤2.5 + ≤1.3, no new logos	Yes

Retention-first levers vs the €5.6M needed, €M, upper bounds



Retention first frees an estimated €1.6M a year versus the CRO plan, held as a gated reserve for AE wave 2

Decisions today: reject 30 AEs, approve €0.8M for onboarding and a first wave of 10 AEs (our sizing), hold an estimated €1.6M until first-year churn is back at 12%

Decisions requested today

Decision	Owner	€M a year	When
Reject the 30-AE plan as proposed	Board	3.6	Today
Approve restoring onboarding to 14 people	CEO / VP CS	0.8	Q1 2026
Approve a first wave of 10 AEs (our sizing)	CRO	1.2 (est.)	Q1 2026
Hold the rest as reserve for AE wave 2	CFO	1.6 (est.)	June 2026 gate

Gate and KPIs

- **Gate (June 2026 board):** first-year churn $\leq 12\%$ and time to first value ≤ 21 days release wave 2
- **Monthly:** first-year churn (from 26%), time to first value (from 48 days), new ARR per AE vs ramp
- **Quarterly:** net new ARR back to the €10.4M of 2024